

UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX

Undergraduate Examinations 2010

CURRENT DISPUTES IN SOCIOLOGY: SOCIOLOGICAL ANALYSIS III

Time allowed: **THREE** hours

Candidates are permitted to bring into the examination room paper dictionaries (with the title in English).

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B**, and **ONE** from **EITHER** Section.

The paper consists of seventeen questions in total: eight in Section A and nine in Section B.

All questions are of equal weight.

**Please do not leave your seat unless you are given permission by an invigilator.
Do not communicate in any way with any other candidate in the examination room.
Do not open the question paper until told to do so.
All answers must be written in the answer book(s) provided.
All rough work must be written in the answer book(s) provided. A line should be drawn through any rough work to indicate to the examiner that it is not part of the work to be marked.
At the end of the examination, remain seated until your answer book(s) have been collected and you have been told you may leave.**

SECTION A

Candidates must answer THREE questions in total: one from Section A, one from Section B, and one from either Section.

1. Should sociology study facts or meanings?
2. What are the advantages and limitations of the Marxist approach to social theory?
3. Compare and evaluate the accounts of causality offered by critical realism and positivism.
4. Whose description of the scientific process is more plausible: Popper's or Kuhn's?
5. Is knowledge gendered?
6. Can sociologists explain the *content* of scientific knowledge or only the processes by which it is produced?
7. Outline and assess Edward Said's concept of 'Orientalism'.
8. How are language, thought and theory related?

END OF SECTION A

SECTION B

Candidates must answer THREE questions in total: one from Section A, one from Section B, and one from either Section.

9. Why is Foucault interested in the micro-techniques of power and how does he describe them?
10. How does Bourdieu explain the relationship between taste, cultural consumption and class?
11. How can the concept of 'myth' be used to analyse contemporary society?
12. What is distinctive about 'reflexive modernity'? How useful is the notion for understanding contemporary social relations?
13. 'The cultural schizophrenia of postmodern subjectivity is a product of contemporary capitalism'. Critically discuss this statement.
14. Is capitalism sustainable?
15. "Differences between women make 'feminism' impossible". Discuss.
16. Why does Habermas think that communicative rationality creates the possibility of a progressive politics?
17. *Either:*
 - (a) Discuss the impact of any one social movement on contemporary social theory;
 - or*
 - (b) Social life is everywhere contested. Using one case study, discuss the ways in which social theory handles this problem.

END OF SECTION B

END OF PAPER SC301-6-FY